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Introduction to Business Frameworks
Session - 4

19th September, 2026

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Agenda

1 District - Owning the decision moment

2 Decision Making framework - Trade-offs



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Crux of the case

What should District do to become the app people open when they have not decided anything yet?

It is essentially a habit formation + discovery + frequency + LTV problem.

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District is already growing 60%. So why does Eternal need to solve anything?

- Growth can hide weak engagement — volume ≠ habit.
- May be over-reliant on external discovery, letting competitors own the customer relationship first.
- Movies and restaurants are inherently low-frequency categories.
- Real opportunity: build frequency of consideration, not just add supply.

<u>Current behavior</u>
Need/idea → Instagram / WhatsApp / friend → District → transaction

<u>Desired behavior</u>
“What should we do?" → District → discovery → decision → transaction

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What are occasions that District should prioritize?

Occasions with enough frequency to generate habitual usage

Occasion	Frequency	Discovery need	Social	Monetization	Our supply fit
Concerts	Low	High	High	High	High
Movies	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	High
Dining	Medium	High	High	Medium	High
Date night	Medium	High	High	High	High
Sports/activities	Medium	High	High	Medium	High
"What to do tonight"	High	Very high	High	Medium	High
Weekend planning	Medium	Very high	High	Medium	Very high

Hence, a good idea should drive Frequency, Decision ownership, Supply leverage, Social/network effects, and LTV

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The Occasion I Own the "What should we do?" moment

- **Occasion**: Friends/couples deciding what to do tonight or this weekend
- Why this occasion?
  - Relatively frequent compared with concerts/events
  - High discovery need
  - Often socially influenced
  - Naturally spans dining, movies, activities and events
  - District already has supply across these categories
- **Strategic ambition:** Move District from "where I book" to "where I decide."

Where District Wins / Loses Today | District owns fulfilment, not planning

- **Today**
  - Instagram / WhatsApp / friends → Decision → District → Booking → Problem
- **Problem**
  - Customer often arrives with intent already formed
  - Social platforms own inspiration
  - Group chats own coordination
  - District enters late
- **Opportunity:** Move upstream

"What should we do?" → District → Plan → Book

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The Idea - District Plans | Tell us the occasion, we'll build the plan

- **User inputs:**
  - Who? — Couple / friends / family
  - When? — Tonight / Saturday
  - Where? — Location
  - Budget
  - Mood
- District generates 3–5 options for plans
- Users can then Save → Share → Vote → Book

District becomes a planning layer across its existing supply, rather than another standalone category.

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The hypothesis I District Plans to increase frequency and cross-category transactions

- LTV = Frequency × AOV × Gross Margin × Lifetime
- Mechanisms:
  - More discovery sessions
  - Higher repeat frequency
  - Cross-category transactions
  - Lower dependence on externally generated intent
- Critical to check f these are incremental orders, and not cannibalized bookings

Fund this via deprioritization of low-frequency initiatives, discounting that doesn't drive stickiness, long-tail category expansion, etc.

90-day test | Prove that users come to District before they have a plan

- **0–30 days: Discovery**
  - Discovery sessions/user
  - Plan creation rate
  - Share/invite rate
- **31–60 days: Conversion**
  - Plan → booking conversion
  - Cross-category booking
  - Incremental orders
- **61–90 days: Habit**
  - Repeat discovery sessions
  - % sessions without pre-existing transaction intent
  - Incremental frequency
  - Contribution/customer

Fund this via deprioritization of low-frequency initiatives, discounting that doesn't drive stickiness, long-tail category expansion, etc.

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Exercise on Hypothesis Formation

The real value isn’t knowing more about a company. It’s knowing something useful enough to change what the seller does next.

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Hypothesis formation & validation I Quick Commerce: Faster Delivery vs Wider Selection

- A quick-commerce company is trying to improve customer retention. The product team has two possible investments:
  - Option A: Faster delivery — reduce average delivery time from 20 to 12 minutes
  - Option B: Wider assortment — increase SKUs available in dark stores by 30%
- The team has enough resources to pursue only one initiative.

How will you test out each hypothesis? What data points do you need?

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Hypothesis formation & validation I Quick Commerce: Faster Delivery vs Wider Selection

Metric	Faster Delivery	Wider Assortment
Users in pilot	20,000	20,000
Current monthly orders/user	2.0	2.0
Repeat-order rate	40%	35%
Repeat-order rate after intervention	50%	40%
Avg. contribution/order	₹30	₹50
Monthly investment	₹12 lakh	₹6 lakh

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Q&A